DAY 15 · THEORY HANDOUT

Write Clear Prompts

Give the model a task, useful facts, and a clear answer shape.

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The idea and its useful terms

Give the model a task, useful facts, and a clear answer shape.

Prompt

The message we send to a language model.

Context

Facts the model can use for this one answer.

Output format

The shape we want back: a list, table, or sentence.

A vague request leaves the model to guess our goal. A clear task tells it what work to do.

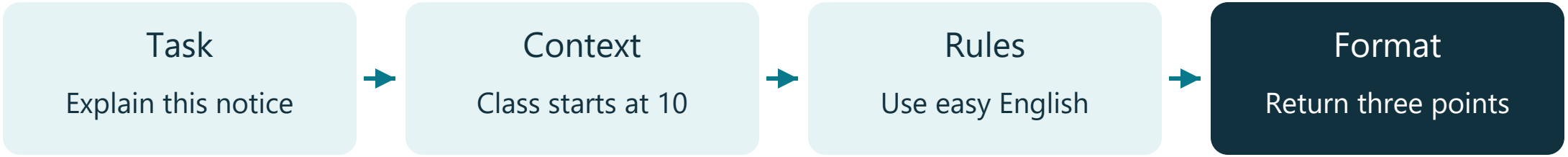
Context gives the facts needed for the answer. The model cannot read a file just because we mention its name.

> A clearer prompt helps guide an answer. It does not make every answer true.

Follow the work, one step at a time

Each step has a job. We can inspect its output before moving on.

Read the path from left to right.



Each arrow means: pass the result to the next step.

The task is the action, such as explain or extract. Context is the source text for that action. A rule limits the answer, such as using only the notice. The format tells the model how to present it.

The model reads the text sent in this request. It cannot see a hidden timetable or an unopened file. If the notice does not say the fee, adding a fee would be a guess.

> If the answer is wrong, inspect the input and the intermediate results. The last sentence alone cannot show which step failed.

A small example we can check

The values here are classroom examples. The notebook shows actual results.

Too vague

Tell me about class.

Which class? Which facts?

Useful facts

Python class: Monday, 10.

Bring a laptop.

Clear request

Explain this notice.

Use three short points.

Read the given input first. Point to the fact or value needed for the requested output.

Run the matching example, then try the fresh input at the end of the notebook. Compare both results with the known input.

> A clearer prompt helps guide an answer. It does not make every answer true.

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Choose the setting or tool for its job

A different choice changes the work. These are the choices we compare.

Task

What should it do?

Explain, extract, compare.

Input data

What should it use?

Paste only useful facts.

Answer shape

What should we receive?

Three points, no guesses.

Rewrite a vague prompt about a class notice. Add the exact notice as context.

Run both prompts. Check facts, length, and missing details.

> Change only the answer format. See whether the facts stay the same.

Practice, check, and read the full lesson

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Use the notebook to try the steps. Use the article when you need the longer explanation.

1. Build

Run the small example.

Inspect each step.

2. Change

Try the fresh input.

Keep the goal clear.

3. Check

Compare with the source.

Keep mistakes visible.

Change only the answer format. See whether the facts stay the same.

Read the complete tutorial breakdown for this section in our KGP Talkie article.

> A clearer prompt helps guide an answer. It does not make every answer true.

DAY 15 · COMPLETE

Thank You

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